Cybersecurity Incident Response — Executive Placemat

Prepared by: Director of Cybersecurity | Audience: CEO, CFO, General Counsel, Board, ELT

🚨 **SUSPECT AN INCIDENT? DO THIS FIRST (0–15 min)**

1. Call Director of Cybersecurity (CTO as backup). Do NOT investigate independently.

2. Preserve evidence — do NOT power off systems, delete files, or contact attacker. Assume all activity is monitored.

3. Switch to Signal (out-of-band). Scan QR code to join channel. Avoid corporate email/Teams if compromise suspected.

🧭 **EXECUTIVE CHECKPOINTS (1–4 hrs)**

- Business Impact: Are critical systems, customer data, or financials at risk? Ongoing or contained?
- Legal & Regulatory: Notify General Counsel immediately. Assess SEC 8-K disclosure, breach notification, and contractual obligations.
- External Engagement: Approve IR firm, cyber insurance carrier, and law enforcement engagement (via Legal).

📢 **COMMUNICATION & DISCLOSURE**

- No media, customer, or internal/external statements without CEO + CFO + General Counsel approval.
- Escalate immediately if: material financial impact, confirmed data exfiltration, or ransomware with operational disruption.
- Material incident disclosure may be required within 4 business days (SEC).

👥 **ROLES**

- CEO — Final decision authority, stakeholder alignment
- CFO — Financial impact, disclosure readiness
- General Counsel — Legal privilege, regulatory compliance
- Director of Cybersecurity — Incident command, technical response
- Communications — Messaging (internal/external)

🔁 **FIRST 24–72 HOURS**

- Situation updates every 2–4 hours. Validate containment. Approve remediation strategy.
- Prepare board notification. Align on external disclosures.

⚠️ **KEY PRINCIPLES**

Speed over perfection · Centralized communication only · Legal privilege matters · Assume breach until proven otherwise

✅ **ANNUAL READINESS REQUIREMENTS**

Participate in tabletop exercises. Review this placemat and validate contacts annually.

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